

turmoil allowed him to get his hands dirty, jump right in to work out the problems plaguing the company and the sector, and listen to customers, suppliers and employees on the company's challenges and strengths.

Over the past 10 years, Jindal has managed not just to understand the company and the sector but also lay out a blueprint for the future, be it in terms of creating more awareness about stainless steel, investing in renewable capacity and sustainability, or charting out an ambitious expansion plan.

The formative experience has stood Jindal in good stead. He remains relatively unfazed by the threat of the tariff war that US President Donald Trump has unleashed.

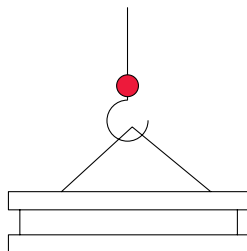
"There has been a dip in our exports over the last three to four years, but because of our long customer relationships, we are still catering to all of them," he says. He adds the company is expanding its reach beyond the US and Europe to the Middle East, South America and even Japan. No wonder Jindal is the winner in the **Urban Visionary** category of the BT-PwC India's Best CEOs 2025 list. His company, Jindal Stainless, India's top stainless-steel producer and among the top 10 globally in terms of output, reported a consolidated annual sales of ₹39,081 crore in FY24. It had 16 manufacturing and processing facilities in India and abroad, including in Spain and Indonesia.

A Boston University graduate in Economics and Business Management, Jindal is upbeat about domestic sales on the back of increasing demand for stainless steel and rising per capita incomes as well as the government's focus on capital investments, all of which bode well for the company.

Vipul Prasad, CEO and Founder of Sebi-registered portfolio manager Magadh Capital, says Jindal Stainless' market dominance and scale, geographical diversification (market as well as manufacturing sites), rich product mix, and control over supply chain are ensur-

THE CURRENT MOOD

- 01 **Domestic demand remains strong with steel consumption rising by 11% annually**
- 02 **Usage of stainless steel is increasing across different industries and sectors**
- 03 **Global headwinds remain, US tariff threat a possible concern**
- 04 **However, the export markets remain subdued**
- 05 **Cheap, sub-standard imports and dumping from China are big worries**



ing that its return ratios are improving sustainably. "A strong balance sheet and prospects of strong volume expansion place the company well for the likely improvement in stainless steel market growth," he says.

Jindal Stainless has revised its volume growth guidance to 10% for the current fiscal, nearly half of what it was expecting at the start of FY25, due to a subdued export market. But Jindal highlights the company is still delivering volume growth.

Brokerage Anand Rathi, in its update after the results of the third quarter of FY25, sounded confident about the prospects of the company.

"Due to robust domestic demand and improvement in the value-added product segment, it maintained its consolidated Ebitda guidance of [more than] ₹20,000 per tonne. Despite imports increasing 5% quarter-on-quarter and export volumes dipping, the company was able to strengthen its presence across niche segments such as lifts and elevators, auto, white goods and metro," it said in a note.

Jindal has a clear strategy of growing the company, which is a part of the supply chain of various international biggies like Gillette, several nuclear power projects, and car manufacturers. This became necessary as there has been a big shift in the stainless steel landscape. Until the 1990s, almost 80% of stainless steel was used for making utensils. Now, it's only 30-35%; the rest goes to industries such as chemical, ethanol, sugar and infrastructure (for instance, railways).

Stainless steel consumption in India is growing around 11% per annum, faster than any other metal. "Our company also wants to grow at the same pace," says Jindal.

Bullish about growth, Jindal Stainless announced a three-pronged investment strategy involving ₹5,400 crore to boost capacity (at present three million tonnes per annum or MTPA) in May 2024. This included a 49% partnership